

HALCYON

A SHORT FILM SCRIPT

FADE IN:

EXT. HALCYON CITY - DAWN

A city built like a canyon. Towers of raw concrete rise out of a cracked salt flat, so tall their tops vanish into low brown cloud. No green anywhere. Between the towers, pipelines as thick as highways snake upward, groaning under pressure.

A single figure, MARA OKAFOR (40s, engineer's coveralls, sun-scoured face), stands on a gantry a thousand feet up, dwarfed by pipe. She presses a gloved hand to the metal. Listens.

SUPER: HALCYON CITY, DAY 4,112 OF THE RATION

INT. WATER MINISTRY, CONTROL FLOOR - CONTINUOUS

Vast. Silent. Rows of terminals face a wall of screens showing pressure gauges, all red. Workers move like monks, slow and deferential to the machines.

Mara sits at a terminal, running a diagnostic. A junior tech, EASSON (20s, nervous), hovers.

EASSON

Sector Nine's still showing full pressure. That can't be right, we cut Nine's ration in March.

MARA

(not looking up)

Maybe the gauge is broken.

EASSON

It's not broken. I checked. Twice.

Mara stops typing. Looks at him for the first time.

EXT. SECTOR NINE, HIGH ABOVE THE CITY - DAY

A wide shot: an entire district floats above the smog line, connected to the rest of the city by a single elevated causeway. Green shows here, actual green, trees, a strip of blue water catching the light like something from a memory.

Mara stands at the causeway checkpoint, dwarfed by a gate twelve feet high. A GUARD studies her credentials.

GUARD

Ministry business up here?

MARA

Pressure anomaly. Routine check.

GUARD

*(beat, then waves her
through)*

Routine.

He says it like it isn't.

EXT. SECTOR NINE, RESERVOIR - CONTINUOUS

Mara walks the shore of a private reservoir the size of a lake. Sprinklers hiss across a lawn. Somewhere, children laugh, unseen.

She crouches, touches the water. Real water. More than she's touched at once in eleven years.

Her radio crackles.

EASSON (V.O.)

(through radio, low)

Mara, don't come back through the main gate. They flagged your badge four minutes ago.

EXT. CAUSEWAY - SUNSET

Mara runs along the raised walkway, city spread below her like a dead circuit board, a thousand feet down. Behind her, gate lights begin to flash. Ahead, the causeway narrows toward the smog.

She doesn't look back. Wide shot: one small figure on a thread of concrete, between two worlds, neither one hers.

INT. MARA'S APARTMENT, SECTOR ONE - NIGHT

A single room. A ration tap on the wall, metered, a small red digital number counting down her monthly allowance: 4L REMAINING.

Mara sits on the floor with a data drone spread open on a cloth, its casing cracked. Easson arrives, breathless, closes the door behind him.

EASSON

They know you were up there.

MARA

Good.

EASSON

Good?

MARA

(quiet, resolved)

Then they know I know.

She holds up a data chip.

MARA (CONT'D)

Eleven years of "drought." Sector Nine's reservoir alone could refill this whole block for a decade. It was

never dry, Easson. It was never once dry.

EXT. CITY SQUARE, RATION LINE - DAWN

The city's largest public square. Hundreds of citizens in a line that curls out of frame, waiting at a single communal tap, each holding a jug. Silent. Patient. The wide shot swallows them, tiny against the concrete canyon.

Mara walks the length of the line, chip in her fist. She stops. Faces the crowd. Says nothing yet, just holds up the chip, catching the weak morning light.

A beat. Then another. Heads start to turn.

EXT. CITY SQUARE - CONTINUOUS, LATER

A public screen mounted on a tower flickers, cuts from a Ministry advisory to raw drone footage: the green lawn, the private lake, the sprinklers hissing in the dawn light.

The line doesn't move. Nobody reaches for their jug. Every face is turned up at the screen instead, lit pale blue by water they've never seen.

Mara stands at the base of the tower, small among them, watching the crowd watch the truth.

FADE OUT.

END.